

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Participation ladder

INFORMATION -> told after the decision; scheme publicity and proactive disclosure; not participation

CONSULTATION -> asked, decision-maker not bound; 2014 policy and the engagement platform

INVOLVEMENT -> take part in planning; village assembly in plan approval; ward meetings

CO-DECISION -> determine an outcome; participatory budgeting; assembly approval under PESA

CO-PRODUCTION -> produce the outcome jointly; community monitoring, user groups, social audit

DELEGATED CONTROL -> run the service; community-managed schemes with their own accountability

MUST REMEMBER: Participatory governance distributes voice across information,...

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: The Indian participation paradox

MOST INSTITUTIONALISED -> pre-legislative consultation and the citizen-engagement platform

THEIR RUNG -> consultation, the weakest rung above being merely informed

MOST CO-DECISIONAL -> participatory budgeting over a defined share of a municipal budget

ITS SCALE -> scattered municipal and ward pilots rather than a universal practice

FINDING -> the forms of participation are institutionalised and the substance is not

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Consultation policy status card

INSTRUMENT -> Pre-Legislative Consultation Policy, 2014

CONTENT -> publish the draft with explanatory material; ordinarily at least thirty days

EXCEPTIONS -> stated exceptions apply and the window may be curtailed

STATUS -> executive policy, not a statute; comments are not binding

GAP -> no general duty to publish a reasoned response to objections

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Named participation forums

VILLAGE ASSEMBLY -> all registered voters in a Panchayat area; test: what can it decide

WARD COMMITTEE -> Article 243S; municipalities of three lakh or more; State law on composition

PARTICIPATORY BUDGETING -> co-decision over a defined budget share; pilot-scale in India

SCHEDULED AREAS -> PESA assembly powers; consultation before acquisition, not consent

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Why decisions drift upward

- ADMINISTRATIVE CONVENIENCE -> one design is simpler to run than hundreds of local variants
- > CAPACITY ARGUMENT: genuine and self-fulfilling where authority is never given
- > POLITICAL-CONTROL INCENTIVE: discretionary allocation carries political credit
- > INFORMATION LOSS: local report to block to district to State to Union, filtered each step
- > DECISION WITHOUT CURRENT LOCAL INFORMATION
- > OUTCOME MISMATCH: wrong design, wrong sequence or arriving too late to be useful

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Two separations inside one demand

SEPARATION FROM INFORMATION -> the decision-maker lacks accurate, current local knowledge

SEPARATION FROM EXECUTION -> the decision-maker lacks awareness of and accountability for delivery

WHY IT MATTERS -> each has a different corrective and merging them loses the analytical mark

FIX FOR THE FIRST -> relocate priority-setting; FIX FOR THE SECOND -> relocate answerability

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Attendance is not participation, consultation is not consent, public...

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Counterweight card

LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION -> scale in large infrastructure; inter-regional equity

LEGITIMATE CENTRALISATION -> specialised technical capacity; rights that must not vary locally

ELITE CAPTURE -> a local forum can reflect a dominant caste or economic group

CAPTURE SAFEGUARDS -> reservation, rotation, facilitation, disclosure, quorum, social audit

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Eight deliberation design tests

- 1 AUTHORITY -> is the forum deciding, or advising on a decision already taken
- 2 TIMING -> is it consulted before the options are foreclosed
- 3 INFORMATION -> budget, options and trade-offs in usable form and language
- 4 INCLUSION -> who is absent: women, landless, migrants, disabled persons, the poorest
- 5 FACILITATION -> independent facilitator, or the implementing agency running its own hearing
- 6 RECORD AND RESPONSE -> objections recorded and a reasoned response published
- 7 FEEDBACK LOOP -> does the participant learn what happened to the input
- 8 IN CONFLICT -> recognised representatives, agreed facts and a route to a binding outcome

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Consultation feedback matrix

COLUMN 1 -> stakeholder category that raised the issue

COLUMN 2 -> issue raised, stated in the objector's own terms

COLUMN 3 -> government response, accepted or rejected, with reasons

COLUMN 4 -> resulting change to the draft, if any

COLUMN 5 -> unresolved distributional effect that remains after the change

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Partnership forms kept distinct

CONTRACTING -> the state buys delivery from a provider against a specification

CONVERGENCE -> several public agencies align at the point of delivery

CO-PRODUCTION -> citizens produce the outcome jointly through monitoring and user groups

PUBLIC-PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP -> risk and finance shared under a contract

RISK -> shared work becomes nobody's work unless one duty-holder stays identifiable

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Who is absent from the forum

WOMEN -> attendance, speaking time and proxy participation are three different measures
LANDLESS AND MIGRANT HOUSEHOLDS -> often outside the electoral roll the forum rests on
THE POOREST -> bear the highest relative wage and time cost of attending
MINORITIES WITHIN THE VILLAGE -> a majority forum can decide against them
CONSEQUENCE -> participation is not a substitute for rights protection

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Answer spine for a participation demand

OPEN -> subsidiarity as an information and execution argument, not as a democratic slogan

BUILD -> place the named mechanism on the ladder and ask what it can actually decide

CORRECT -> name legitimate centralisation and elite capture as the two counterweights

CLOSE -> design conditions, absent participants and a graded verdict with no invented count

EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Gram Sabhas, ward committees,...